FIGHTERBASE

Carb cycling

Food list

Every allowed and avoided food, by type. More carbs on hard days, fewer on easy days.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this quick guide

This quick guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Carb cycling**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Quick timing guide** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Carb cycling is an eating pattern, so it has a timing guide instead of a list of banned foods.

AT A GLANCE

Carb cycling on one page

Carbs change with the training day: higher on sparring or double-session days, lower on rest days. Combine with any style.

The big ideas

1. High-carb days match hard or long training.
2. Low-carb days match rest days or light sessions.
3. Protein stays steady on every day.
4. Fat tends to move the opposite way to carbs: more on low-carb days, less on high-carb days.
5. Total food and training matter more than the exact cycle.

Timing guide

Day type	Carbs	Typical foods
High-carb day (hard sparring, conditioning, long session)	High	Rice, potatoes, oats, pasta, fruit, bread, lean protein, low fat
Moderate day (technical or lighter session)	Medium	Some rice or potato with meals, fruit, vegetables, protein
Low-carb day (rest or very light)	Low	Protein, vegetables, salad, eggs, nuts, olive oil, a little fruit

Talk to a professional first if: You have diabetes or take medication that needs food; You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18; You have ever had an eating disorder; You are cutting weight for a fight.

READ THE LABEL

Hidden things to look out for

- Carbs per serving matter more than 'sugar'
- Starch hides as maltodextrin, modified starch, flour
- Check sauces and drinks on low-carb days

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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